

Word family: **challenge / challenges / challenged / challenging / challenger / unchallenged**

Base word: challenge

Plural: challenges

Past tense: challenged

Past participle: challenged

** -ing form:** challenging

Related forms: challenger, unchallenged

Useful constructions/extensions: take on a challenge, accept a challenge, face a challenge, pose/present a challenge, rise to the challenge, challenge yourself, challenge someone to + activity, challenge a decision/claim/assumption, legal challenge

Part of speech: noun(名詞) / verb(動詞) / adjective-related form **challenging** (相關形容詞)

Your passage contains both **challenging** and **challenge**:

> “One of the most **challenging** things I have ever done was giving a formal presentation in English at a company event last year.”

and:

> “To handle the **challenge**, I prepared in a very practical way.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **challenge / challenging** refers to something that is **difficult and demanding enough to require considerable effort, courage, skill, or determination**.

It does **not** mean that somebody was questioning your authority, disputing a claim, or inviting you to compete.

The presentation was a **challenge** because:

- * you had to speak English in front of around two hundred colleagues;
- * you had little previous experience speaking to such a large audience in English;
- * public speaking made you nervous;
- * you were worried about making mistakes and being judged;
- * you nevertheless had to prepare carefully and go through with it.

Meaning: A difficult situation or task that tests a person's abilities, confidence, determination, or resources.

繁體中文: **一件具有相當難度，需要運用能力、努力、勇氣或毅力才能應付或完成的事情／考驗**

中文翻譯:

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever done was giving a formal presentation in English at a company event last year.”

「我做過其中一件****最具挑戰性、最考驗自己能力和勇氣的事情****，就是去年在一個公司活動上用英文作正式簡報。」

> “To handle the challenge, I prepared in a very practical way.”

「為了****應付這項困難的考驗／挑戰****，我採取了一個很實際的方法去準備。」

So:

****a challenge = 一件需要付出相當努力、能力、勇氣或毅力才能克服或完成的困難事情****

****challenging = 難度較高、會考驗人的能力或毅力的****

1. ****a challenge = difficult task/situation (困難任務／情況) — 挑戰; 難題; 考驗****

This is the basic meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Something difficult that requires effort, ability, determination, or problem-solving.

Practice 1 — Original

> “To handle the ****challenge****, I prepared in a very practical way.”

「為了****應付這項具有相當難度的挑戰****，我採取了一個很實際的方法去準備。」

Practice 2

> “Learning to manage a large team was a major ****challenge**** for her.”

「學習管理一個大型團隊對她來說是一項****很大的挑戰／相當困難的任務****。」

Practice 3

> “Finding enough qualified staff remains a serious ****challenge**** for the company.”

「找到足夠合資格的員工，對公司而言仍然是一項****難以解決的重要問題／挑戰****。」

****a challenge = 一件因難度、限制或要求較高而需要相當努力、能力或資源才能處理的事情****

Common patterns:

* **face a challenge** = 面對挑戰
* **deal with a challenge** = 處理挑戰
* **handle a challenge** = 應付挑戰
* **overcome a challenge** = 克服挑戰
* **a major/serious challenge** = 重大的挑戰

2. **challenging = difficult but requiring skill/effort (需要能力和努力的) — 具挑戰性的; 有難度的**

This is the exact form used in your opening sentence.

Meaning: Difficult in a way that requires considerable thought, effort, skill, courage, or persistence.

Practice 4 — Original

> “One of the most **challenging** things I have ever done was giving a formal presentation in English.”

「我做過其中一件**最具挑戰性、最考驗自己能力的事情**，就是用英文作正式簡報。」

Practice 5

> “The course is **challenging**, but I am learning a lot.”

「這個課程**很有難度、相當具挑戰性**，但我學到很多東西。」

Practice 6

> “Managing several projects at the same time can be extremely **challenging**.”

「同時管理幾個項目可以是**非常困難、很考驗管理能力的**。」

challenging = 難度較高，需要運用能力、思考、努力或毅力才能妥善應付的

Important nuance:

challenging does not always mean simply **bad** or **unpleasant**.

A task can be:

> **challenging but rewarding**

= **雖然困難而具挑戰性，但完成後很有滿足感／很值得**

3. **challenge + person/ability/system (考驗某人／能力／系統) — 考驗; 要求發揮能力**

Here **challenge** is a **verb**.

Meaning: To put somebody or something in a situation that requires considerable ability, thought, effort, or performance.

Practice 7

> “The new role will **challenge** you in ways your previous job did not.”

「這個新職位會在很多方面**考驗你的能力**，是以前工作沒有的。」

Practice 8

> “The exercise is designed to **challenge** students without overwhelming them.”

「這項練習的設計目的是適度**考驗學生的能力**，但又不至於令他們難以應付。」

challenge someone/something = 對某人的能力、思考或承受力提出較高要求，使其受到考驗

This is closely related to meanings #1 and #2:

* **a challenge** → 困難考驗

* **challenging** → 具有相當難度、考驗能力的

* **challenge someone** → 使某人的能力受到考驗

4. **challenge yourself = deliberately attempt something difficult (主動挑戰自己) — 挑戰自己; 突破自己的能力範圍**

A very useful modern construction.

Meaning: To deliberately attempt something difficult in order to test, improve, or extend your abilities.

Practice 9

> “I decided to **challenge myself** by volunteering to give the presentation.”

「我決定自願做簡報，以此**挑戰自己、突破自己的舒適範圍**。」

Practice 10

> “Try to **challenge yourself** instead of always choosing the easiest option.”

「不要每次都選最容易的方法, 可以嘗試**給自己一些挑戰、提升自己的能力**。」

challenge yourself = 主動選擇較困難的事情, 以測試、提升或突破自己的能力

This fits the broader lesson of your passage particularly well.

5. **challenge + claim/idea/assumption/belief**(說法／觀點／假設) — 質疑; 對.....提出異議

This is a genuinely different meaning.

Here, **challenge** does not mean “make something difficult.”

It means **question whether something is true, correct, reasonable, or justified**.

Practice 11

> “Several researchers **challenged** the assumption that the method was effective.”

「幾位研究人員**質疑了這個方法有效的假設**。」

Practice 12

> “The evidence **challenges** the traditional view of what happened.”

「這些證據對傳統說法**提出了質疑／令傳統觀點受到挑戰**。」

challenge a claim/idea/assumption = 對某個說法、觀點或假設是否正確提出質疑, 要求重新檢視

Common objects:

- * challenge an assumption
- * challenge a belief
- * challenge a theory
- * challenge a claim
- * challenge an interpretation
- * challenge conventional thinking

6. **a challenge to + claim/authority/system**(對說法／權威／制度的質疑) — 質疑; 異議; 挑戰

The same questioning concept can appear as a **noun**.

Practice 13

> “The report represents a serious **challenge to** the official explanation.”

「這份報告對官方解釋構成了嚴重的**質疑**。」

Practice 14

> “His argument was seen as a direct **challenge to** the traditional view.”

「他的論點被視為對傳統觀點的直接**挑戰／質疑**。」

a challenge to something = 對某項說法、規則、權威或既有觀點的正確性／合理性提出異議

Compare:

> **a difficult challenge**

= 困難的考驗

but:

> **a challenge to an assumption**

= 對某項假設提出質疑

The Chinese word 「挑戰」 may work for both, but the underlying English concepts are different.

7. **challenge + decision/ruling/law**(決定／裁決／法律) — 正式提出異議; 要求推翻或重新審查

This is especially common in **legal, administrative, workplace, and formal institutional English**.

Meaning: To formally dispute a decision, rule, result, or legal action and seek to have it reviewed or changed.

Practice 15

> “The company plans to **challenge** the court’s decision.”

「公司計劃對法院的裁決**提出法律上的異議, 要求重新審視或推翻**。」

Practice 16

> “Employees can **challenge** the decision through the formal appeals process.”

「員工可以透過正式上訴程序對該決定**提出異議並要求覆核**。」

challenge a decision/ruling = 正式質疑某項決定或裁決是否合法／合理, 並要求有關機構重新審查

This develops from the broader “question/dispute” meaning, but it is an important formal application.

8. **legal challenge = formal attempt to dispute something through law (法律挑戰) — 法律上提出異議／司法挑戰**

A useful fixed professional expression.

Practice 17

> “The new regulation is facing a **legal challenge**.”

「這項新規例正面對**法律上的司法挑戰／有人透過法律程序質疑其有效性**。」

Practice 18

> “The organization launched a **legal challenge** against the decision.”

「該組織就這項決定**提出法律訴訟／透過司法程序提出異議**。」

legal challenge = 透過法院或其他法律程序, 正式質疑某項決定、規例或行動是否合法或有效

9. **challenge someone to + contest/activity (向某人發出比試邀請) — 向……挑戰; 邀請比賽**

This is another genuinely different meaning.

Meaning: To invite or dare somebody to compete with you or prove their ability.

Practice 19

> “He **challenged** his colleague to a game of chess.”

「他向同事**發出挑戰, 邀請對方下一場棋**。」

Practice 20

> “The runner **challenged** the champion to a race.”

「那名跑手向冠軍**挑戰, 要求和他比賽**。」

challenge someone to something = 向某人提出比試或競爭, 要求對方證明能力

Common patterns:

* **challenge someone to a race**

* **challenge someone to a game**

* **challenge someone to a contest**

* **challenge someone to a debate**

10. **challenge someone to + verb (激將／要求對方證明自己) — 挑戰某人去做.....**

This extends beyond formal competition.

It can mean **daring somebody to do something difficult, bold, or uncomfortable**.

Practice 21

> “I **challenge you to give** the presentation without reading from your notes.”

「我**挑戰你嘗試**不看筆記完成這次簡報。」

Practice 22

> “She **challenged the team to find** a better solution.”

「她**要求團隊接受挑戰, 找出**一個更好的解決方法。」

challenge someone to do something = 要求／激勵某人嘗試完成一件有難度的事情, 以證明或提升能力

Depending on tone, it can sound:

* competitive;

* encouraging;

* provocative.

11. **a challenge = invitation to compete/prove ability (比試邀請) — 挑戰書; 比試要求**

The corresponding noun meaning.

Practice 23

> “The champion accepted his opponent’s **challenge**.”

「冠軍接受了對手的**挑戰／比試要求**。」

Practice 24

> “She issued a **challenge** to anyone who thought they could beat her.”

「她向所有認為能擊敗她的人**公開發出挑戰**。」

****a challenge = 邀請另一人進行比試、競爭或能力較量的要求****

Common:

> **accept a challenge**

> = 接受挑戰

> **issue a challenge**

> = 發出挑戰

12. **challenger = person/team trying to defeat the current winner (挑戰者) — 挑戰者; 競爭者**

This is an important family member.

****Meaning:**** A person, team, organization, etc. attempting to defeat someone who currently holds a leading position or title.

Practice 25

> “The champion defeated the **challenger** in the final round.”

「冠軍在最後一回合擊敗了**挑戰者**。」

Practice 26

> “A strong new **challenger** has entered the market.”

「市場上出現了一個實力強勁的新**競爭者／挑戰者**。」

challenger = 嘗試擊敗目前領先者、冠軍或主導者的人／團體／公司

The business use is figurative:

> **a challenger brand**

= 試圖挑戰市場領導品牌地位的競爭品牌

13. **challenge for something** (比賽／競爭) — 爭奪……; 競逐……

Especially common in **sport and competition**.

Practice 27

> “The team is expected to **challenge for the title** this season.”

「預計這支球隊今季會有力**爭奪冠軍**。」

Practice 28

> “Several athletes are **challenging for** first place.”

「幾位運動員正在**競逐第一名**。」

challenge for + title/position = 積極參與競爭, 希望取得某個冠軍、地位或名次

This is related to competitive **challenge**, but the grammatical pattern is worth learning.

14. **challenge (sports)** = attempt to take the ball / stop an opponent (體育比賽中的攔截／搶球) — 攔截; 搶球動作

An established sports meaning, especially in football/soccer.

Practice 29

> “The defender made a clean ****challenge**** and won the ball.”

「後衛作出了一次乾淨的****攔截／搶球動作****，成功取得皮球。」

Practice 30

> “The referee gave him a yellow card for a dangerous ****challenge****.”

「球證因為他作出危險的****攔截動作****而向他出示黃牌。」

****a challenge = 球員嘗試從對手腳下取得球權或阻止對方前進的搶截動作****

This is a domain-specific meaning, but common enough for learners who encounter sports English.

15. ****pose/present a challenge (某事造成困難) — 構成挑戰; 帶來難題****

A very common academic, professional, and formal collocation.

Practice 31

> “The tight deadline ****poses a major challenge**** for the team.”

「緊迫的期限對團隊****構成重大挑戰／帶來很大的困難****。」

Practice 32

> “Rapid population growth ****presents significant challenges**** for city planners.”

「人口迅速增長為城市規劃人員****帶來重大的難題和挑戰****。」

****pose/present a challenge = 某個情況本身造成需要解決的困難或問題****

Notice:

> ****I face a challenge.****

= 我面對挑戰。

> ****The situation poses a challenge.****

= 這個情況構成／帶來挑戰。

The grammatical perspective changes.

16. ****take on / accept a challenge** (主動接受困難任務) — 接受挑戰; 承擔難題******

These are important fixed constructions.

Practice 33

> “She decided to ****take on the challenge**** of managing the new department.”

「她決定****接受管理新部門這項挑戰****。」

Practice 34

> “I was nervous, but I eventually ****accepted the challenge****.”

「我雖然很緊張, 但最後還是****接受了這項挑戰****。」

****take on / accept a challenge = 願意承擔或嘗試完成一件有相當難度的事情****

This describes exactly the decision you made in your passage when your supervisor asked you to present.

17. ****rise to the challenge = perform successfully when facing difficulty** — 面對挑戰時發揮能力; 迎難而上******

A very useful idiomatic expression.

****Meaning:**** To respond successfully when a difficult situation demands greater effort, courage, or ability.

Practice 35

> “She was nervous at first, but she ****rose to the challenge****.”

「她一開始很緊張, 但最後****迎難而上, 在挑戰面前發揮出了自己的能力****。」

Practice 36

> “The team ****rose to the challenge**** and completed the project on time.”

「團隊****成功應付了困難的考驗****, 並準時完成項目。」

****rise to the challenge = 面對困難要求時沒有退縮, 反而發揮能力並成功應付****

This expression fits your presentation story especially naturally.

18. ****unchallenged = not questioned/disputed (沒有受到質疑的) — 未受質疑的; 沒有人反駁的****

This develops from ****challenge = question/dispute****.

Practice 37

> “His version of events remained ****unchallenged**** for years.”

「多年來, 他對事件的說法一直****沒有受到質疑或反駁****。」

Practice 38

> “The assumption should not be allowed to go ****unchallenged****.”

「這個假設不應該在****完全沒有人質疑的情況下****被接受。」

****unchallenged = 某個說法、觀點或決定沒有被人提出異議、質疑或反駁****

Very common expression:

> ****go unchallenged****

= 沒有人質疑／沒有受到挑戰

19. ****unchallenged = without a serious rival (沒有受到競爭威脅的) — 無可匹敵的; 沒有真正競爭者的****

A second useful sense of ****unchallenged****, developing from competitive ****challenge****.

Practice 39

> “For years, the company remained the ****unchallenged**** market leader.”

「多年來, 該公司一直是****沒有真正競爭對手的市場領導者****。」

Practice 40

> “She was the **unchallenged** champion in her category.”

「她一直是該組別中**無人能真正挑戰其地位的冠軍**。」

unchallenged = 某人的領先、冠軍或主導地位沒有受到有力競爭者威脅

Important distinction: challenge vs problem

These words can overlap, but they do not feel identical.

problem

= something wrong or undesirable that needs to be solved

> “We have a technical **problem**.”

「我們遇到了一個技術**問題**。」

challenge

= something difficult that requires effort, ability, ingenuity, or determination

> “Managing the project is a **challenge**.”

「管理這個項目是一項**很考驗能力的挑戰**。」

A **challenge** can sometimes have a more positive or growth-oriented feeling.

For example:

> “It was difficult, but I enjoyed the **challenge**.”

「雖然很困難, 但我很享受這種**考驗自己的感覺**。」

It would sound stranger to say:

> “I enjoyed the problem.”

unless you specifically mean you enjoyed solving it.

So:

****problem = 需要解決的不理想情況／問題****

****challenge = 困難度較高而需要運用能力和努力去應付的事情****

Important distinction: **challenging vs difficult**

They overlap strongly.

**difficult**

simply says something is not easy.

> “The exam was ****difficult****.”

「考試很難。」

**challenging**

often emphasizes that the task ****tests your ability, effort, skill, or determination****.

> “The job is demanding but ****challenging****.”

「這份工作要求很高，但亦很****有挑戰性、能考驗能力****。」

Therefore:

****difficult = 困難、不容易****

****challenging = 不容易，而且需要投入能力、思考、毅力或努力才能完成****

Because of this, ****challenging**** can sometimes sound more positive than ****difficult****.

Important distinction: **challenging vs demanding**

**challenging**

= difficult enough to test ability or determination

**demanding**

= requires a great deal of time, energy, attention, skill, or effort

Compare:

> “The course is **challenging**.”

「課程難度高，很考驗能力。」

> “The job is physically **demanding**.”

「這份工作對體力要求很高。」

Something can be both:

> “It is a **challenging and demanding** role.”

= 工作既有難度，又對人的時間、精力或能力要求很高。

Important distinction: **challenge** = difficulty vs **challenge** = question/dispute

This is one of the most important polysemy distinctions.

Difficulty:

> “Public speaking was a **challenge** for me.”

= 公開演講是一項**困難的考驗**。

Question/dispute:

> “She **challenged** his claim.”

= 她**質疑**他的說法是否正確。

These require completely different mental concepts.

Important distinction: **challenge** someone vs **challenge** something

challenge someone

can mean:

1. test their ability;

> “The task **challenged** me.”

= 任務**考驗**了我的能力。

2. invite/dare them to compete or act;

> “He **challenged** me to a race.”

= 他**向我提出比賽挑戰**。

challenge something

often means:

> question or dispute it

> “They **challenged** the decision.”

= 他們**對決定提出異議**。

The object after **challenge** is therefore extremely important for understanding its meaning.

Important distinction: **challenging** vs **challenged**

These should not be confused.

challenging

= causes difficulty / requires ability

> “It was a **challenging** presentation.”

「那是一場**很具挑戰性的**簡報。」

challenged

usually functions as the past tense/past participle of **challenge**:

> “The experience ****challenged**** me.”

「這次經歷****考驗了我****。」

> “The decision was ****challenged**** in court.”

「這項決定在法院受到****司法質疑／挑戰****。」

So:

****challenging = 造成挑戰的****

****challenged = 已受到考驗／質疑／挑戰的, 視動詞語境而定****

Usage warning

Expressions such as ****physically challenged**** or ****mentally challenged**** have historically been used as euphemisms referring to disability.

They may now sound dated, awkward, or inappropriate depending on context.

For modern neutral English, it is generally clearer to use the specific appropriate term, such as:

* ****a person with a physical disability****

* ****a person with an intellectual disability****

Therefore I would ****not**** treat those expressions as a core meaning learners should actively reproduce.

Family-extension sweep

The practical ****challenge**** family is not enormous, but several extensions are highly useful:

* ****challenge — difficult task**** = 困難而需要努力應付的考驗

* ****challenging**** = 困難而會考驗能力的; 具挑戰性的

* ****challenge someone/something**** = 考驗某人／某物

* ****challenge yourself**** = 主動挑戰自己、突破能力

* ****challenge a claim/assumption**** = 質疑某項說法／假設

* ****challenge a decision/ruling**** = 正式對決定／裁決提出異議

* ****legal challenge**** = 透過法律程序提出正式質疑

* ****challenge someone to something**** = 向某人提出比試

* ****challenge someone to do something**** = 激勵／要求某人嘗試有難度的事情

* **challenger** = 挑戰者／試圖擊敗領先者的競爭者
 * **challenge for a title/position** = 爭奪冠軍／地位
 * **sports challenge** = 攔截／搶球動作
 * **pose/present a challenge** = 構成挑戰／造成難題
 * **take on / accept a challenge** = 接受挑戰
 * **rise to the challenge** = 迎難而上、成功應付考驗
 * **unchallenged — not disputed** = 未受質疑的
 * **unchallenged — without rival** = 沒有真正競爭者、地位未受威脅的

I would **not** artificially add obscure derivatives merely to enlarge the family.

The main learning value comes from the strong contrast between:

> **difficulty / test of ability**

and

> **question / dispute / competition**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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a challenge — difficult task/situation	一件因難度、限制或要求較高，需要運用相當努力、能力、勇氣或資源才能應付的事情
challenging	難度較高，需要運用能力、思考、努力或毅力才能妥善應付的
challenge someone's ability	令某人的能力、思考或承受力受到較高度度的考驗
challenge yourself	主動嘗試有難度的事情，以測試、提升或突破自己的能力
challenge a claim/idea/assumption	質疑某項說法、觀點或假設是否正確、合理或有充分根據
a challenge to a claim/authority	對某項說法、規則、權威或既有觀點提出異議或質疑
challenge a decision/ruling	正式質疑某項決定或裁決，並要求重新審查或改變
legal challenge	透過法院或法律程序正式質疑某項決定、規例或行動是否合法／有效
challenge someone to a contest	向某人提出比試或競爭，要求對方證明能力
challenge someone to do something	要求、激勵或激將某人嘗試完成一件具有難度的事情
a challenge — competition invitation	向另一人提出比試、競爭或能力較量的要求
challenger	試圖擊敗目前冠軍、領先者或主導者的人、團隊或組織
challenge for a title/position	積極參與競爭，希望取得某個冠軍、名次或地位
challenge — sport	球員嘗試從對手取得球權或阻止對方前進的攔截／搶球動作
pose/present a challenge	某種情況本身造成需要投入能力、努力或資源才能解決的困難
take on / accept a challenge	願意承擔或嘗試完成一件具有相當難度的事情
rise to the challenge	面對困難要求時迎難而上，發揮能力並成功應付
unchallenged — not disputed	某項說法、觀點或決定沒有受到質疑、異議或反駁

| ****unchallenged — without rival****

| 某人的領先、冠軍或主導地位沒有受到有力競爭者威脅

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For your original passage

> “One of the most ****challenging**** things I have ever done was giving a formal presentation in English at a company event last year.”

The exact meaning is:

****challenging = 因為難度和心理壓力較高，需要運用相當的準備、能力、勇氣和毅力才能完成的****

Therefore:

> ****one of the most challenging things I have ever done****

= ****「我做過其中一件難度最高、最考驗自己能力和勇氣的事情」****

And later:

> “To handle the ****challenge****, I prepared in a very practical way.”

Here:

****challenge = 這場英文簡報所帶來的困難和考驗，包括面對大量觀眾、使用非母語公開演講，以及克服緊張和害怕被評價的心理壓力****

So in your passage, the core mapping is:

****challenge = 需要靠準備、能力、勇氣和毅力去克服的困難考驗****

****challenging = 具有這種難度、會考驗人的能力和勇氣的****

The word is therefore especially appropriate here because the experience was not merely ****difficult****: it actively ****tested your confidence, English-speaking ability, preparation, and willingness to face something you had previously been afraid of****.